

Session 5: Color-Evasive Practices

Pework and Session Agenda

This week, participants will be asked to reflect on whether they have engaged or witnessed color-evasive rhetoric or practices in academic spaces, and how this knowledge, in combination with the knowledge of racialized experiences, has shaped how they will mentor students.

Pework

Objective: Provide participants with a general understanding of color-evasive practices and how they harm people of color.

- **Activities:**
 - **TED Talk:** [Color Blind or Color Brave?](#) by Mellody Hobson
 - Note: Since 2014, the ableist term “color blind” has been replaced by “color evasive.”
 - **Video:** [Color Evasiveness](#) by Angela Davis
- **Reflection:** Consider the following statements. How does each statement lack a racial awareness lens? What are the potential effects of these statements on students of color? For each statement, what situation is more likely to be true?
 - **Statement A:** "I think if students of color just felt more confident and asked for help, they would be fine."
 - **Statement B:** "In some communities, families just don't have the same love of science."
 - **Statement C:** "It's not racial, it's about students who are from low-income schools that are underprepared."
 - **Submission:** Be ready to share your questions and reflections during the live session.

Agenda

- 0 - 5 min – Welcome, ice breaker in chat
- 5 - 10 min – Intro to color evasiveness
- 10 - 25 min – Full group discussion on homework reflections
- 25 - 30 min – BREAK
- 30 - 40 min – Paired breakout, responses to scenarios
- 40 - 55 min – Full group discussion about scenarios
- 55 - 60 min – BREAK
- 60 - 85 min – Full group discussion: color evasiveness in mentoring practice
- 85 - 90 min – Wrap up